

HCC Established 1926

The Rs 3,000 crore company is eyeing a Rs 20-30,000 crore order over the next five years from the massive Indian nuclear pie

HEMANT CHAWLA/www.indiatodaymag.com

Ajit Gulabchand 62, CMD

POWERING INDIA

It is a monopoly to create India's best, its firsts as well as some of the world's largest, but no one is complaining. Certainly not the people who are reaping the dividends of HCC's nation building tasks, whether it be a bridge that connects people or a sea link that joins the city to its suburbs. In a span of eight decades, HCC has emerged at the forefront of India's engineering construction industry with global management practices—its specialisation cutting across construction, real estate and infrastructure development. Its hydro-power exploits include 18 major barrages and 22 dams.

From the world's longest barrage at Farakka, West Bengal (2,253 m), and the world's fourth-longest at Sone, Bihar (1,407 m), to the

world's largest water treatment plant, from powering nearly every landmark project in the power sector to creating the Bandra-Worli sea link—the first open sea bridge in India—it has been a journey of acquiring indepth knowledge, expertise and effective project co-ordination skills. This legacy today ensures an order book of around Rs 15,400 crore. Along the way, HCC, which was registered as a company in

January 27, 1926, has reached many milestones—from 1941 when it became a Rs 1 crore company to the Rs 3,000 crore mark in 2008.

"We are now developing India's largest hill city, Lavasa, a three-hour drive from Mumbai, spread across 12,500 acres with 60 km of lake-front," says chairman and

"We want to become the customers' preferred choice through innovation, modern technologies and delivering projects on time."

managing director Ajit Gulabchand, who relies on the 3,000-strong creamy layer of manpower and more than 25,000 workers to carry forward his dream. Nuclear power is the next big thing on HCC's agenda. Though at a nascent stage, Gulabchand sees the total opportunity at about Rs 50,000 crore to Rs 1 lakh crore. It has already built over 50 per cent of India's nuclear power generation capacity, including all six phases of the Rajasthan Atomic Power Project. "Now we are eyeing about Rs 20-30,000 crore of the nuclear pie," says Gulabchand.

The mandate to build India is not without its responsibilities. The company harvests, reuses and recycles water at its sites and even won a UN award on water management. Such attention to detail is what makes a business leader.

By Nivedita Mukherjee

40 per cent
of contracts for construction of roads in India experience cost overrun of between 25 and 50 per cent.